A delicious fall soup for the whole family. Purée it for the younger members, so they get to eat their required vegetables without noticing.

potato and clam soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 25 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 30 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

2¼lb (1kg) clams
¼ cup dry white wine
2–3 tbsp olive oil
2 celery ribs, finely diced
1 red onion, finely chopped
1 carrot, finely chopped
4 tomatoes, peeled, seeded, and chopped
2 medium potatoes, finely diced
1 quart (l liter) cold water
1 sprig of rosemary
1 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf parsley or chervil
salt and freshly ground black pepper
4–6 slices thick country bread

1 Wash the clams thoroughly in cold running water, throwing away any with broken shells and any that are open and won't close when gently tapped. Put them in a large frying pan with the wine, cover with a lid, and place over high heat for 5 minutes or until the shells open. Discard any that remain closed, as they will not be edible. Drain, reserving the liquid. Remove the clams from their shells, place in a bowl, cover, and refrigerate until needed. Strain the cooking liquid through a fine sieve.

2 Heat the oil in a large heavy-bottomed pan, add the celery, onion, and carrot, and cook on low heat for 10 minutes or until light brown. Add the tomatoes, potatoes, the reserved cooking liquid, and the water, and bring to a boil. Add the rosemary, then lower the heat, cover with a lid, and simmer for 1 hour.

3 Stir in the clams and the parsley or chervil, then season with salt and freshly ground black pepper. Remove the rosemary, put a slice of bread in the bottom of each bowl, and ladle over the soup.